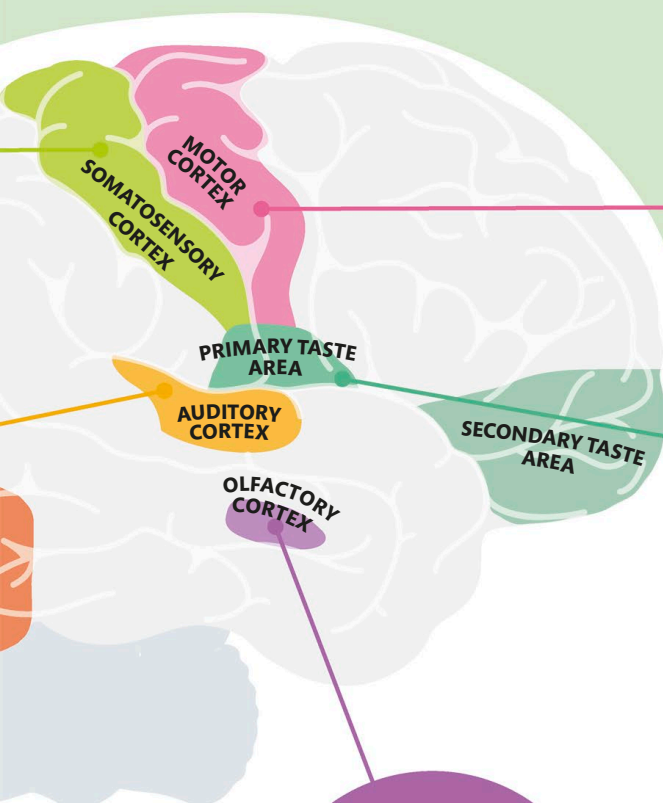




Proprioception

The brain is constantly processing information from the joints and muscles that tell it where the body is in space. It keeps us upright and allows us to make movements without conscious effort, such as walking up stairs.



Taste

Taste is important in determining what is safe and nutritious to eat. Taste receptors pick up only five basic tastes: sweet, salty, bitter, sour, and umami (savory). We need our sense of smell to help identify a taste.



Smell

Despite having only 400 smell receptors, humans can detect up to a trillion different odors. Smell is important for survival as it warns us of hazardous substances or events, such as something burning. It also plays a key role in taste.



Sense areas of the cortex

Inputs from the sense receptors map to different areas of the brain's cortex. Although these areas are separate, they can often react to inputs from another sense. For example, visual neurons will respond better in low-light situations if they are accompanied by sound.

HOW MANY SENSES ARE THERE?

Including the six senses described here, scientists think there may be as many as 20 senses, based on the number of different receptor types in the body.